



LINUX vs. WINDOWS PERSPECTIVE FROM THE FENCE

From greybeards to newbies, what do you think?

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Let us get this clear from the start! This is NOT your run of the mill Linux vs. Windows “which is better than the other” comparison. Think of this as an aggregation of thoughts from user’s with varying years of experience, all bundled into one clean, up to date package. And with speed being the theme of the month, we are also throwing in some bonus stats from some speed tests we conducted.

Do you have ten minutes?

Our approach to what you – the user’s think was pretty straightforward. We asked a whole bunch of user’s who had been exposed to the two computing environments what their thoughts were on certain aspects of each OS and asked for a vote on which they thought was a winner (or a tie). This questionnaire first spammed inboxes in our office and then grew into the community (thinkdigit.com/ forum) where it recieved a fairly good response as well.

We found that all users who participated in the feedback had a minimum of 6 years of Windows experience and the *nix experience ranged from 10 days to 14 years! User’s were



then categorised based on number of years of computer related experience and we brought on the onslaught.

The consensus

Let’s take it from the top where almost everyone thought one edged out the other. 88% of users agreed that Linux provides better default programs post installation and frankly, we agree. Then again, there are two sides to every story. Though Linux user’s may have the benefit of better post install applications like an image editor, pdf reader, email client, Bittorrent client, office suite and Firefox as the browser, Windows boasts the best 3rd party support with powerful applications like the Adobe/

Speaking of browsers, the poll showed that almost all users found Firefox a better alternative to Internet Explorer. With the new and much improved version (IE 9) now though, Microsoft seems to have a better grip on security than before. Overall, Firefox has been receiving a lot of flak off late and Microsoft is trying to regain lost ground so we recommend you read up on the latest buzz on browsers before you take a call on your browser of choice. Also check out a feature in Connections regarding what’s going wrong with the open source browser.



Corel suite, a more powerful Microsoft Office (if you have the money) suite and here’s the trump card – GAMES! Linux has simply not seen the plethora of games that are available at the Windows’ users disposal, which deters many from considering the open source alternative.

65% of the users that voted either Windows or Linux in the customisation section felt that though Windows had a much better overall audio visual

appeal, the customisation options that Linux software like Compiz Fusion and TweakUI offered were better. Some users reported that giving so many choices was confusing. Networking was another place where users felt Windows was easier